Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
Strategic Policy, Transportation and Economic Corridors, Government of Alberta

Re: Senior Policy Advisor (Requisition 88758)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for the Senior Policy Advisor position in Strategic Policy. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and I did my master's degree in transportation engineering at the University of Alberta.

The posting describes policy research, options analysis and briefing materials for senior officials, and that is the kind of writing I do. At the City I research policy questions as they come up, looking at how City policy, provincial legislation and the work of other levels of government bear on them, and I write the briefing notes and memos that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff. I advise on by-laws and regulations, and with policy staff I have helped report to Council on new transportation regulations. I coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations.

I also bring a technical grounding that policy staff do not always have. At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services, and at the City I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brings several years of travel survey data into one validated source. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not worked on provincial legislation or Cabinet materials, or done Gender-Based Analysis Plus. I have not prepared requests for proposals or managed contractors through an evaluation, and I have not led stakeholder engagement with Indigenous communities or other ministries. My degrees are in engineering rather than public administration or political science, though the posting names a related field and I have worked in policy support for about three years. I have not worked in Alberta's government, and I would need to learn its processes.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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